Rob op den Kelder

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Work Authorization: EU Citizen & UK Settled Status

Principal Engineer & Technical Adviser | Technology Strategy | Enterprise Architecture | Azure & AI

Summary

Hands-on Principal Engineer and technical adviser with 17+ years building, de-risking and modernising enterprise systems across energy, aviation, finance and government. The engineer organisations turn to when delivery is on the line: sought out across teams and by the business for architecture and connectivity decisions, and brought in for scoped, high-stakes assignments, from legacy modernisation to partner integration and integration security, delivered end to end. Engineered the solutions behind £150M+ in contracts, led 40+ globally distributed engineers, and drives modern AI-assisted and agentic engineering across teams.

Career highlights

- £150M+ in multi-year UK government contracts, won on solutions I engineered (KPMG).
- Transavia: retired a legacy AS-400 workload (€48k/yr saved) and protected partners through a core reservation platform upgrade with zero outages.
- Led 40+ globally distributed engineers across DevOps, Data, QA & Software.
- Direct enterprise feedback to the Microsoft Teams product team at Microsoft HQ, Redmond.
- Drove adoption of AI-assisted and agentic engineering across teams (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, MCP).

Core competencies

- **Strategic Leadership & Delivery:** Technical strategy & roadmap, architecture governance, engineering leadership & mentoring (40+), customer technical enablement, stakeholder & vendor management, agile delivery.
- **AI-Assisted & Agentic Engineering:** GitHub Copilot & Copilot CLI, Claude Code, Model Context Protocol (MCP), authoring reusable Claude skills, and driving team adoption of agentic workflows.
- **Cloud & Distributed Systems:** Microsoft Azure (Solutions Architect Expert), cloud-native & event-driven architecture, microservices, enterprise integration, VNET/private endpoints, IaC (Bicep, Terraform).
- **Core Technologies:** C#/.NET, .NET Aspire, React.js, PowerShell; Azure Functions (Durable & Event-Driven), Service Bus, SQL & NoSQL (Cosmos DB), Power BI; exploring Rust, Go, Apache Kafka.
- **Security & Operations:** DevSecOps (Fortify, SonarQube), security-first design, Azure DevOps, CI/CD.

Work experience

Freelance Principal Technology Consultant — **Transavia**
April 2023 - Present
Four fixed-term assignments via Kelderro — Schiphol, Amsterdam Area, The Netherlands

- **Secure Partner Gateway (2026):** Designed and built a .NET gateway behind Azure API Management that limits each travel partner to its allowed endpoints, with in-depth request and response filtering

and masking; moved the logic out of APIM policies, which proved inflexible and hard to test, into a unit-tested .NET service.

- **GenAI-Assisted Delivery (2026):** Planned and built the gateway with a coding agent, then presented the approach, timeline and adoption steps to other teams and at Transavia's internal AI guild; two tech leads requested a knowledge-sharing session so their own teams could adopt it.
- **Reservation Platform Upgrade (2024 - 2025):** Ran the partner impact analysis for a core reservation platform upgrade, adapted integration endpoints to shield API/B2B partners and briefed partners on required changes; breaking changes were caught before go-live, with zero partner outages.
- **Legacy Modernization & Cost Reduction (Jan - Apr 2024):** Replaced an AS-400 crew-evaluation tool with event-driven Azure serverless (Event Grid, Functions, Storage), enabling AS-400 decommissioning and saving €48k/year in mainframe run costs.
- **Crew Compensation Automation (Apr - Dec 2023):** Architected a .NET Aspire, Durable Functions and Power BI platform to automate manual crew compensation, saving 1 FTE and delivering executive analytics.

Independent Technical Advisor

Jun 2022 - March 2023

Architecture Advisory The Hague Area, The Netherlands

- **Architecture & Security Audit:** Conducted end-to-end technical assessments for a client following third-party vendor delivery, providing strategic recommendations on code maintainability, security posture, and system scalability.

Principal Software Engineer / Architect **KPMG LLP**

Oct 2015 - May 2022

KPMG Technologies Canary Wharf, London, United Kingdom

(Promotions: Experienced Technical Lead, Feb 2017 - Oct 2018 | Technical Lead, Dec 2015 - Feb 2017 | Senior Software Engineer, Oct 2015 - Dec 2015)

- **Microsoft Co-Engineering:** Partnered with embedded Microsoft CSE teams on multi-week sprints to optimize platform performance, and engaged the Microsoft Teams product team at Microsoft HQ (Redmond) with enterprise feedback on real-world product limitations and proposed enhancements.
- **Hands-On Cloud Engineering:** Engineered and deployed scalable, event-driven microservices on Microsoft Azure (C#/.NET), with Azure Service Bus (queues and topics) as the messaging backbone, delivering the core technical solution that secured **£150M+ (nine-figure) in multi-year UK government contracts**.
- **Hands-on Technical Leadership:** Mentored and led **40+ globally distributed engineers** across DevOps, Data, QA, and Software. Provided technical authority for product architecture while conducting code reviews, pen testing, and CI/CD security automation. This included onboarding and mentoring a neurodivergent engineer via auticon.
- **Engineering Enablement & Knowledge Sharing:** Presented regularly to QA, DevOps and Engineering teams to roll out new tooling and best practices and lift adoption, and ran lessons-learned sessions on recent hurdles, sharing the reasoning behind key decisions so teams avoided repeating mistakes.
- **Multi-Cloud Expertise:** Architected solutions across both Azure and AWS environments using C#.NET, PowerShell, React.js, and Infrastructure as Code (Terraform).

Freelance Software Consultant **Kelderro**

Jan 2015 - Oct 2015

Custom Software & Client Delivery The Hague Area, The Netherlands

- **End-to-End Ownership:** Single-handedly designed, built and delivered a complete custom system for a medium-sized business, carrying full lifecycle and end responsibility while working directly with non-technical stakeholders to turn business needs into a working solution.

Consultant: Senior Software Engineer **CGI, Royal Dutch Shell**

Sep 2010 - Nov 2014

Shell Finance Department and Shell technology The Hague, The Netherlands

- **Global Reservoir Tracking System & SME Collaboration:** Partnered with Reservoir Engineers to modernize a global reservoir management system tracking worldwide oil reserves, streamlining volume reporting and **global asset visibility**.
- **SOX Compliance:** Delivered with **100% SOX compliance**.

Education and Certifications

- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert** Microsoft | 2019 - Present
- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science** University of Applied Sciences, Rotterdam

Outside work activities

- **Pro Bono IT Strategy Advisor | Non-Profit Organizations / Small Businesses:** Trusted advisor to non-technical leaders across local non-profits, including leading IT procurement for an animal shelter; translated vendor proposals into clear business guidance.